Jacob Scott

Game Designer • Games User Researcher

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OBJECTIVE

Aspiring game designer and user researcher with hands-on experience shipping commercial titles at USC Games. Passionate about designing meaningful, accessible challenges through strategy and tactics games — with a focus on moment-to-moment decision-making, enemy behavior, and player experience. Proven ability to lead playtests, synthesize findings into actionable design improvements, and collaborate on large multidisciplinary teams.

EDUCATION

B.A., Interactive Media and Game Design May 2025

University of Southern California, Los Angeles, CA · Graduated *cum laude*

EXPERIENCE

Lead Games User Researcher · *USC Games* 2023 – Present

Unchained: Tale of Enra *(2024 – Present)*

- Sole user researcher on a 50+ person commercial game team, independently owning the full research pipeline from study design to reporting.
- Conducted hundreds of playtests, synthesizing observations into clear, actionable design recommendations that directly influenced iteration.

Bugnauts! *(2023 – 2024)*

- Co-led playtest facilitation and reporting on a 50+ person team alongside one other researcher on a shipped commercial title.

Game Designer · *USC Games* 2021 – Present

Unchained: Tale of Enra *(2024 – Present)*

- One of 4 designers on a 50+ person team; responsible for level design, systems design, and enemy design on a commercial tactical RPG.

Bugnauts! *(2023 – 2024)*

- Prototyped enemy attack patterns, AI behavior, and level layouts; authored and maintained design documentation throughout development.
- One of 4 designers contributing to a shipped commercial 3D action title on a 50+ person team.

Rock, Paper, Scissors, Shoot! *(2023)*

- Designed all enemies and levels for a 2D bullet-hell game; co-implemented mechanics as one of two engineers on a four-person team.

Chimken Crusade *(2022)*

- Sole designer and engineer on a two-person team — prototyped the full concept, all gameplay mechanics, all enemies, and all levels.

Programmer / Engineer · *USC Games* 2022 – 2024

Bugnauts! *(2023 – 2024)*

- Implemented enemy AI systems in a shipped commercial 3D action game.

Rock, Paper, Scissors, Shoot! *(2023)*

- One of two engineers; built core mechanics and enemy behaviors.

Chimken Crusade *(2022)*

- Sole gameplay engineer; implemented all mechanics and enemy logic from scratch.

PERSONAL PROJECTS

Unreal Engine 5 Level Design

- Designed and built a custom 3D environment in UE5, applying professional level-design principles to spatial layout, pacing, and player flow.

Reverse Engineering Fire Emblem

- Reverse-engineered game systems to implement targeted modifications altering player experience — demonstrating deep understanding of game mechanics, balance, and design intent.

SKILLS

Design	Level & Map Design • Systems Design • Enemy Design • Game Prototyping • Design Documentation
Research	Playtest Facilitation • User Research Reporting • UX Analysis • Iterative Feedback Loops
Game Engines	Unity • Unreal Engine 5
Programming	C# • Python • HTML